



Saint Columban College
College of Computing Studies
Pagadian City



Inspect HTML

Inspect HTML 



Easy

Web Exploitation

picoCTF 2022

inspector

AUTHOR: LT 'SYREAL' JONES

Description

Can you get the flag?

Additional details will be available after launching your challenge instance.

This challenge launches an instance on demand.

Its current status is:

NOT_RUNNING

Launch Instance

Hints 

1

110,217 users solved



71%

Liked



 picoCTF{FLAG}

Submit
Flag

Author: The Analyst: Hyposelenia

Challenge: Inspect HTML

Category: Web Exploitation

Date: 02/10/26



I. Objective

The objective of this challenge is to inspect the HTML source code of a webpage to locate and retrieve a hidden flag.

II. Background

Web exploitation challenges often require participants to analyze the **client-side structure of a website**, including HTML, CSS, and JavaScript. Information that is hidden visually on a webpage may still be present in the underlying source code and can be accessed through browser developer tools.

Inspecting HTML is a fundamental skill in cybersecurity, as sensitive data should never be exposed on the client side. This challenge demonstrates how improperly hidden information can be easily discovered through basic inspection techniques.

III. Tool Used

- **Web Browser Developer Tools (Inspect Element)** – Used to view and analyze the webpage's HTML source code

IV. Methodology

1. Launched the challenge instance on the platform.
2. Accessed the provided website link.

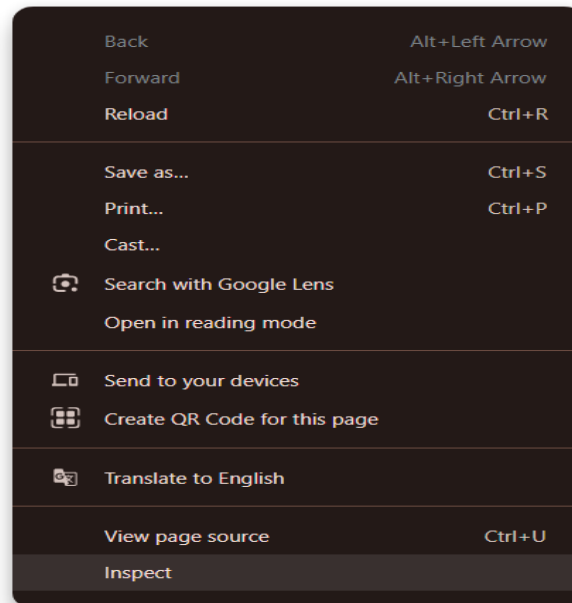
On Histiaeus

However, according to Herodotus, Histiaeus was unhappy having to stay in Susa, and made plans to return to his position as King of Miletus by instigating a revolt in Ionia. In 499 BC, he shaved the head of his most trusted slave, tattooed a message on his head, and then waited for his hair to grow back. The slave was then sent to Aristagoras, who was instructed to shave the slave's head again and read the message, which told him to revolt against the Persians.

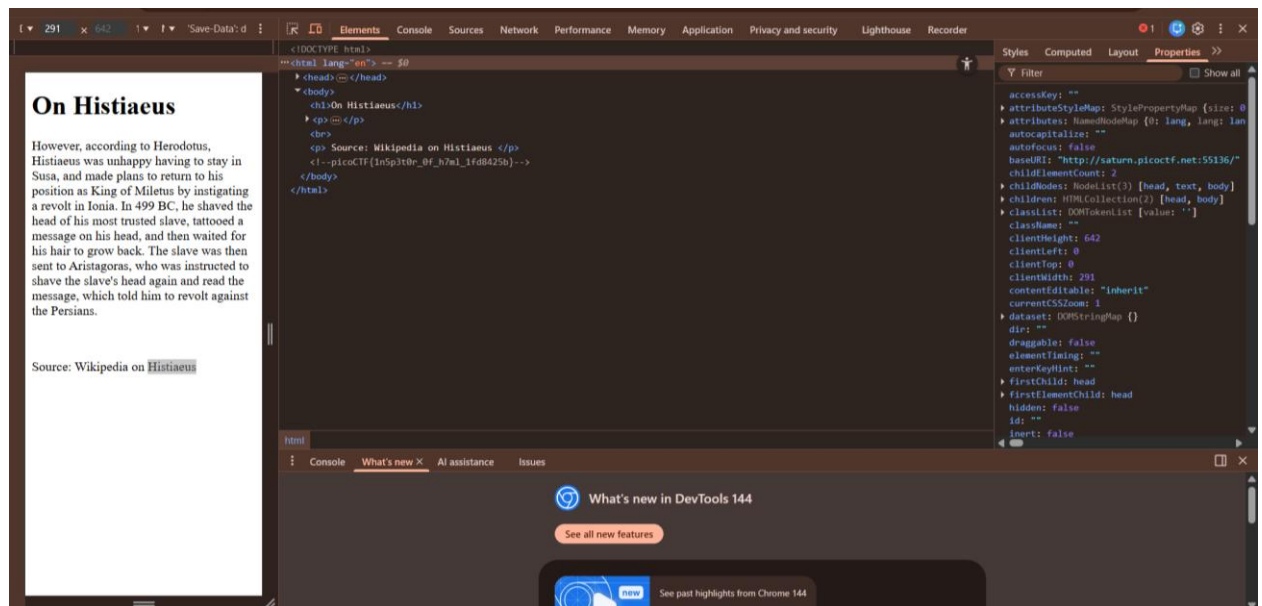
Source: Wikipedia on Histiaeus



3. Read the challenge hint, which suggested using the web inspector.
4. Right-clicked on the webpage and selected **Inspect** to open the browser's developer tools.



5. Examined the HTML source code displayed in the Elements tab.



6. Located the flag embedded directly within the HTML.



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can be retrieved through inspection. It demonstrates a common web security mistake and emphasizes why sensitive information should be handled securely on the server side rather than embedded in HTML.

— **The Analyst: Hyposelenia**